

The Google Business Profile Checklist for Fishing Charters & Seafood

25 things to fix on your Google listing so anglers book direct — not through TripAdvisor Experiences.

TripAdvisor Experiences, Viator and GetYourGuide charge charter operators 20–30% per booking. On a \$1,200 full-day trip that's up to \$360 straight out the door — before you've paid for fuel, bait or crew.

Your Google Business Profile is the single biggest free tool you have to win those bookings direct. This checklist fixes the bits most charter ops and regional seafood sellers get wrong. Takes about an hour. Print it, tick each box as you go.

1. Foundation

THE BASICS — GET THESE WRONG AND NOTHING ELSE MATTERS

☐ Claim and verify your listing

If Google doesn't trust you own the business, you can't edit anything. Search your charter or shop name on Google and look for "Own this business?"

☐ Business name matches your real branding

No keyword stuffing. "Mallacoota Fishing Charters Best Snapper Trips" gets you suspended. Just your real charter name.

☐ Address (or marina / departure point) consistent everywhere

Whether it's a shopfront, a marina berth, or a launch ramp, what's on Google must match exactly what's on your website, invoices and any directory listings.

☐ Phone number is the one anglers actually reach you on

Not a TripAdvisor forwarding number. Your mobile, that you answer (even out on the water if signal allows).

☐ Website link points to your own site

Your own domain, your own booking page. Not your TripAdvisor or Viator listing — that's sending Google traffic straight to a 20–30% commission gate.

2. Categories & Attributes

TELL GOOGLE EXACTLY WHAT YOU DO

- ☐ **Primary category as specific as possible**
"Fishing charter," "Boat tour agency," "Fishing guide," "Fishmonger," "Seafood market" — pick the most specific. "Fishing charter" beats "Tour operator" every time.
 - ☐ **Add 2–4 secondary categories**
"Boat rental service," "Fishing store," "Wholesale fish market," "Tourist attraction" if they apply. Don't pad with things you don't actually offer.
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- ☐ **Tick every relevant attribute — including "booking required"**
Booking required, family-friendly, kid-friendly, gear provided, accessibility (wheelchair-accessible boat, accessible parking). Anglers and parents filter searches by these.

3. Hours, Description & Service Area

WHEN YOU RUN, AND WHERE YOU FISH

- ☐ **Trading hours reflect when you actually take calls / depart**
If departure is 6am, set hours from when the phone gets answered (5am? 6am?). Special hours for weather closures, off-season, and Christmas / Easter / Anzac Day.
 - ☐ **Service area / waters fished listed in the description**
Use the full 750-character description: name the waters (Mallacoota Lakes, Bemm River, offshore from Gabo Island), the towns you depart from, and what makes your charter different (target species, experience, boat).
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- ☐ **Seasonal species + closure dates kept current**
"What's biting now" is the #1 thing anglers want to know. Mention current target species and any seasonal closures in the description; refresh quarterly.

4. Photos

"THE CATCH" SHOTS SELL CHARTERS BETTER THAN ANY COPY YOU'LL WRITE

- ☐ **Customer-with-catch hero shots, well-lit, smiling**
A grinning punter holding a 5kg snapper sells more half-day trips than any photo of a boat. Get permission, get the shot, upload weekly. These are your highest-converting photos — full stop.
 - ☐ **The boat — on the water, daylight, no clutter**
Wide shot showing the boat from the water with passengers visible. People want to know what they're stepping onto. Add interior shots showing seating, shelter, gear.
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☐ **Customers actually on a trip — landscape and lifestyle**

Action shots: someone fighting a fish, the wake behind the boat, gear set up on the deck. Show people having a good time, not posed group photos.

☐ **Scenery + monthly fresh photos**

Sunrise departures, the coastline, where you fish. Add a fresh photo at least monthly — a recent catch, a new species, the day's conditions. Google rewards active listings.

5. Direct Bookings vs Experience-Aggregator Commissions

WHERE THE 20–30% COMMISSION SAVINGS ACTUALLY HAPPEN

☐ **Booking link goes to your own site — not TripAdvisor / Viator**

In the GBP dashboard, set the "Booking" or "Appointments" link to your direct booking page. Even a simple "Call to book" tel: link beats sending Google traffic to a 20–30% commission middleman.

☐ **Order link goes to your own ordering page (seafood retail)**

If you sell fresh catch or processed seafood, set the "Order online" link to your own pre-order page — not a third-party marketplace. Same commission logic: every middleman click is margin you don't see.

☐ **Messaging turned on (and someone's watching it)**

Anglers want to ask "is there room Saturday?" or "what's biting?" without playing phone tag. Big trust signal. Reply within an hour during trading times.

Why this matters

Google now lets people book and message you straight from search results. If your booking link points at TripAdvisor or Viator, you've just paid 20–30% commission on a customer Google sent you for free. Send them to your own booking page (or your own phone number) every single time.

6. Reviews, Posts & Q&A

THE ONGOING WORK THAT KEEPS YOU AHEAD OF QUIETER COMPETITORS

☐ **Reply to every review — good and bad**

Within 48 hours. By name, personalised, never copy-paste. A polite, professional reply to a 2-star ("weather was bad and we couldn't run") wins more new bookings than the bad review costs.

☐ **Ask for the review the day of, while they've still got the catch in hand**

A QR card you hand them at the wharf, a follow-up text within 24 hours with your Google review link, a small printed card next to the EFTPOS machine. Aim for one new review per trip-week minimum.

☐ **Get your short Google review link**

In your GBP dashboard, click "Ask for reviews" — copy that short link, save it as a contact on your phone, hand the QR out at end-of-trip.

☐ **Post an update every 1–2 weeks — especially in season**

"This week's catch," next season's bookings open, weather window coming up, gear changes. Counts as a fresh signal to Google and shows up directly in your listing.

☐ **Pre-load the Q&A section**

Add the questions anglers actually ask — what's included, what to bring, can kids come, do you cater for beginners, weather policy — and answer them yourself. Saves you replying 50 times.

Done it all? Here's what's next.

If you've ticked every box, your Google Business Profile is now in better shape than 95% of charter operators and regional seafood sellers in your patch. Want a hand keeping more of those bookings direct instead of handing 20–30% to TripAdvisor? Get in touch — find me on Facebook or Instagram as Your Mate Agency, or my email and number are right below.

Your Mate Agency — helping regional businesses get found online.

Built by Matt Rowlands in Mallacoota, East Gippsland.

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